

Q.4b (15 marks): Explain the approaches of studying family in Anthropology

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(b)

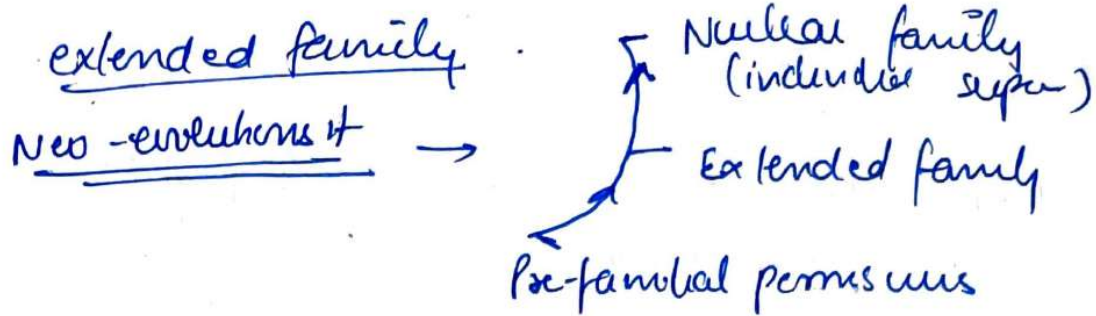
Approaches of studying family in Anthropology.

family as per Murdock is a social institution marked by economic cooperation, reproduction, socialisation, common habitation etc.

Approaches of studying family

With emergence of socio-cultural anthropology study of family got importance in Britain by socio-cultural anthropologist.

① Evolutionary approach - L.H Morgan
in "The System of Consanguinity and Affinity of Human Families" - talked of family as stage in evolution of human being.
Pre-familial persons to the



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② Structuralist approach → Levi Strauss
studied "kinship structure" → family
as form of social institution helps
support social structure

③ Structure-functionalist - family → social institutions
ex → Radcliffe Brown
↓
satisfies social needs
↓
supports "social structure"

Fortes studied complementary relations
in African societies in family
institution

④ Functional approach - Malinowski
argued → family provides → social
security to an individual → satisfies
need → lead to survival of society.

⑤ Marxist approach - consider family as refuge for labour exploitation in outside world. Due to female subordination, state and higher class (with power) enjoy supremacy.

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⑥ feminist perspective - Giddens argues family has been a study from male perspective, neglected female views. As per this approach, female should be equally treated within family.

New emergence David Schneider criticised earlier studies and argued for cultural relevance in the study.

These approaches and post-modernist thought of new families (like live-in relation) makes study of family evolve.